

Word family: **emergency / emergencies / emergency**

Base word: emergency

Part of speech: mainly **noun**, also used attributively before another noun

Related forms:

* **emergency** (n.) — 緊急情況；突發事故；危急狀況

* **emergency** (adj.-like modifier) — 緊急的；應急的

* **emergencies** (plural n.) — 緊急事件；突發事故

* **emergency room / emergency department** — 急症室

* **emergency services** — 緊急服務

* **emergency exit** — 緊急出口

* **emergency contact** — 緊急聯絡人

* **emergency fund** — 應急基金

* **state of emergency** — 緊急狀態

* **in an emergency** — 在緊急情況下

* **emergency measure** — 緊急措施

* **emergency response** — 緊急應變

* **emergency landing** — 緊急降落

Meaning in this passage

> I stopped feeling as if my life was one long **emergency**.

Here, **emergency** is figurative.

It means:

a constant state of crisis in which everything feels urgent and has to be dealt with immediately — 長期處於危機 / 救火狀態

The speaker used to leave everything until the last minute, so life constantly felt like one urgent problem after another.

中文翻譯：

我不再覺得自己的人生像一場永無止境的**緊急狀態 / 危機**。

So here:

emergency = 不是字面上的災難，而是形容生活長期處於「甚麼都很趕、甚麼都要立即處理」的狀態

1. **emergency (緊急情況；危急事件) — 緊急情況；突發事故**

This is the core literal sense.

Practice 1

> Call this number in an **emergency**.

如有**緊急情況**，請致電這個號碼。

Practice 2

> The hospital is prepared for medical **emergencies**.

醫院已準備好應付醫療**緊急事故**。

Practice 3

> We need a clear plan for **emergencies**.

我們需要一套清晰的**緊急應變方案**。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency = 突然發生、需要立即處理，否則可能造成嚴重後果的情況

2. **in an emergency — 在緊急情況下**

Practice 1

> Use this door only **in an emergency**.

只可在**緊急情況下**使用這扇門。

Practice 2

> Everyone should know what to do **in an emergency**.

每個人都應該知道在**緊急情況下**該怎樣做。

MCQ-ready definition:

in an emergency = 當出現需要立即應對的危急情況時

3. **medical emergency — 醫療緊急事故**

Practice 1

> She was taken to hospital after a **medical emergency**.

她因一宗**醫療緊急事故**被送往醫院。

Practice 2

> Chest pain can sometimes signal a **medical emergency**.

胸痛有時可能代表出現**醫療急症**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****medical emergency = 需要立即接受醫療處理的危急健康情況****

4. **family emergency — 家庭緊急事件**

Practice 1

> He left work early because of a **family emergency**.

他因為**家庭突發事件**提早離開工作崗位。

Practice 2

> I may need to cancel if there is a **family emergency**.

如果出現**家庭緊急情況**，我可能需要取消安排。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****family emergency = 家庭中突然發生、需要立即處理的重要事件****

5. **emergency services — 緊急服務**

Practice 1

> The **emergency services** arrived within minutes.

****緊急服務人員**幾分鐘內便到場。**

Practice 2

> Call the ****emergency services**** if someone is in immediate danger.

如果有人有即時危險，請聯絡****緊急服務****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****emergency services = 負責處理事故、火警、醫療急症等的警察、消防、救護等服務****

6. ****emergency room / emergency department — 急症室****

Practice 1

> He was taken to the ****emergency room****.

他被送往****急症室****。

Practice 2

> The ****emergency department**** was extremely busy.

****急症部****非常繁忙。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****emergency room/department = 醫院中處理突發、危急傷病的部門****

7. ****emergency exit — 緊急出口****

Practice 1

> Keep the ****emergency exit**** clear.

保持****緊急出口****暢通。

Practice 2

> Follow the signs to the nearest ****emergency exit****.

跟隨指示前往最近的****緊急出口****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****emergency exit = 發生事故或危險時供人迅速離開建築物的出口****

8. ****emergency contact — 緊急聯絡人****

Practice 1

> Please provide an ****emergency contact****.

請提供一名****緊急聯絡人****。

Practice 2

> Her sister is listed as her ****emergency contact****.

她的姐姐被列作她的****緊急聯絡人****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****emergency contact = 發生緊急情況時應首先聯絡的人****

9. ****emergency number — 緊急電話號碼****

Practice 1

> Save the local ****emergency number**** in your phone.

把當地的****緊急電話號碼****儲存在電話裏。

Practice 2

> He called the ****emergency number**** immediately.

他立即撥打****緊急求助電話****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****emergency number = 用於聯絡警察、消防、救護等緊急服務的電話號碼****

10. ****emergency response — 緊急應變****

Practice 1

> The company reviewed its **emergency response** procedures.

公司檢討了其**緊急應變程序**。

Practice 2

> A fast **emergency response** reduced the damage.

迅速的**緊急應變**減少了損害。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency response = 對突發危急情況所採取的即時應對行動

11. **emergency measure — 緊急措施**

Practice 1

> The government introduced several **emergency measures**.

政府推出了數項**緊急措施**。

Practice 2

> Closing the building was an **emergency measure**.

關閉大樓是一項**緊急措施**。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency measure = 為立即處理危機而暫時採取的措施

12. **emergency fund — 應急基金；應急儲蓄**

Practice 1

> Everyone should try to build an **emergency fund**.

每個人都應盡量建立一筆**應急基金**。

Practice 2

> Her **emergency fund** covered the unexpected repair bill.

她的**應急儲蓄**支付了突如其來的維修費。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency fund = 預留給突發開支使用的金錢

13. **emergency supplies — 緊急物資；應急用品**

Practice 1

> Keep basic **emergency supplies** at home.

家中應備有基本**應急物資**。

Practice 2

> The shelter distributed **emergency supplies**.

庇護中心派發了**緊急物資**。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency supplies = 為災害、事故或其他危急情況預先準備或立即提供的物資

14. **emergency landing — 緊急降落**

Practice 1

> The plane made an **emergency landing**.

飛機進行了**緊急降落**。

Practice 2

> A technical problem forced an **emergency landing**.

技術問題迫使飛機**緊急降落**。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency landing = 因安全或技術問題而非原定計劃進行的緊急著陸

15. **state of emergency — 緊急狀態**

A formal legal/government sense.

Practice 1

> A **state of emergency** was declared after the disaster.

災難後宣布進入**緊急狀態**。

Practice 2

> Special powers may apply during a **state of emergency**.

在**緊急狀態**期間，可能會實施特殊權力。

MCQ-ready definition:

state of emergency = 當重大危機發生時，由當局正式宣布的特殊法律或行政狀態

16. **emergency (figurative : 危機狀態) — 危機；救火狀態**

This is the exact branch used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I stopped feeling as if my life was one long **emergency**.

我不再覺得人生像一場沒完沒了的**危機 / 救火狀態**。

Practice 2

> Poor planning made every deadline feel like an **emergency**.

規劃不善令每個截止日期都像一場**緊急危機**。

Practice 3

> Not every problem needs to become an **emergency**.

不是每個問題都需要變成一場**緊急狀況**。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency = figurative: 一種所有事情都顯得非常急迫、必須立即處理的危機狀態

17. **create an emergency — 製造危機 / 令事情變得緊急**

Practice 1

> Leaving everything until the last minute **creates unnecessary emergencies**.

把所有事情拖到最後一刻會**製造不必要的危機**。

Practice 2

> Poor communication turned a small problem into an **emergency**.

溝通不良把一個小問題變成了**緊急局面**。

MCQ-ready definition:

create an emergency = 令原本可控制的問題變得迫切和危急

18. **emergency mode — 緊急模式；救火模式**

Often figurative in workplace/productivity contexts.

Practice 1

> I was constantly working in **emergency mode**.

我一直都在**救火模式**下工作。

Practice 2

> Good planning helps teams avoid permanent **emergency mode**.

良好規劃有助團隊避免長期處於**緊急應付模式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

emergency mode = 一種只顧立即處理迫切問題、缺乏長期規劃的工作狀態

Important distinction 1: **emergency vs urgency**

emergency

a situation requiring immediate action because serious harm may result.

urgency

the quality of needing quick attention.

> medical emergency

> 醫療急症

> a sense of urgency

> 迫切感

Not everything urgent is an emergency.

Important distinction 2: **emergency vs crisis**

emergency

often immediate and action-focused.

crisis

broader serious turning point or unstable situation, sometimes lasting longer.

> emergency = 現在需要立即處理

> crisis = 嚴重而不穩定的危機局面

They overlap strongly.

Important distinction 3: **emergency vs accident**

accident

an unplanned harmful event.

emergency

the dangerous situation requiring immediate response.

An accident can create an emergency, but they are not the same thing.

Important distinction 4: **emergency vs disaster**

disaster

a very damaging event, often large-scale.

emergency

focuses on the need for immediate action.

A disaster almost always creates emergencies, but an emergency does not have to be a disaster.

Important distinction 5: **emergency vs problem**

problem

any difficulty.

emergency

a serious problem requiring immediate attention.

> broken pencil = problem

> fire in the building = emergency

Important distinction 6: **emergency vs immediate**

emergency

noun describing the situation.

immediate

adjective meaning without delay.

> emergency treatment

> 緊急治療

> immediate treatment

> 立即治療

Related, but grammatically and semantically different.

Important distinction 7: **emergency room vs urgent care**

emergency room / department

for potentially serious or life-threatening urgent problems.

urgent care

for conditions needing prompt attention but not necessarily emergency-level treatment.

The exact healthcare systems vary by place, but this distinction is useful conceptually.

Important distinction 8: **state of emergency vs emergency**

emergency

the actual crisis.

state of emergency

a formal legal/administrative status declared in response to a crisis.

Not every emergency leads to an official state of emergency.

Important distinction 9: **emergency fund vs savings**

savings

money kept for future use generally.

emergency fund

money specifically reserved for unexpected essential expenses.

So an emergency fund is a kind of savings with a specific purpose.

Important distinction 10: **life was one long emergency**

This is metaphorical hyperbole.

It does **not** mean the speaker was literally facing:

- * fires,
- * accidents,
- * medical crises,
- * disasters.

It means:

everything felt constantly urgent because poor planning kept creating last-minute pressure

Important distinction 11: **emergency as attributive noun**

In expressions like:

- * **emergency exit**
- * **emergency fund**
- * **emergency response**

emergency functions before another noun like an adjective, but grammatically it is traditionally analyzed as a noun modifier.

For learners, the practical meaning is simply:

「緊急 / 應急用的」

Family-extension note

Emergency has a stable core:

a serious, unexpected, or dangerous situation requiring immediate action

From that core come:

1. **literal crises**

- * medical emergency
- * family emergency

2. **services and facilities**

- * emergency services
- * emergency room
- * emergency exit

3. **preparedness**

- * emergency contact
- * emergency fund
- * emergency supplies

4. **response**

- * emergency measures
- * emergency response
- * emergency landing

5. **formal legal status**

- * state of emergency

6. **figurative urgency**

- * life feels like an emergency
- * emergency mode

For your passage, the exact branch is:

figurative crisis mode caused by constant last-minute pressure

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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emergency	緊急情況；危急事故	immediate danger/problem	
in an emergency	在緊急情況下	urgent context	
medical emergency	醫療急症	health crisis	
family emergency	家庭突發事件	family crisis	
emergency services	緊急服務	police/fire/ambulance	
emergency room	急症室	hospital emergency care	
emergency exit	緊急出口	escape route	
emergency contact	緊急聯絡人	person to call	

emergency number	緊急電話號碼	emergency communication	
emergency response	緊急應變	immediate action	
emergency measure	緊急措施	crisis action	
emergency fund	應急基金	unexpected expenses	
emergency supplies	緊急物資	preparedness	
emergency landing	緊急降落	aviation	
state of emergency	緊急狀態	formal legal status	
emergency (figurative)	危機；救火狀態	constant urgency	
emergency mode	緊急 / 救火模式	reactive working	

For your original sentence

> I stopped feeling as if my life was one long **emergency**.

Here:

one long emergency = 生活長期處於「甚麼都拖到最後一刻、甚麼都很急、永遠在救火」的狀態

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我不再覺得自己的人生像一場永無止境的**緊急狀態 / 危機**。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **problem** = 有問題

> **urgent** = 很趕

> **emergency** = **事情嚴重而且迫切到必須立即處理**

In this passage, the word is intentionally figurative: the speaker's old routine made **ordinary responsibilities feel like repeated emergencies**.